

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 3
♥ A J T 6
♦ Q 8 3 2
♣ K J 3

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4



♠ T 5
♥ K Q 4 3
♦ J T 5 4
♣ A T 7

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 9 5 2

♦ K 9

♣ 9 8 6 2

NORTH has an opening hand, 15 points, and a 5-card ♠ suit. Unfortunately WEST beat her to the punch by opening 1♥.

But NORTH should get into the bidding anyway, by Overcalling 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

SOUTH has 6 points. If NORTH had actually OPENED 1♠, SOUTH would be obligated to bid. But knowing that the Overcall will not be made with more than 16 points, SOUTH just passes.

West

1♥

All Pass

1♠ by North

North

1♠

East

South

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ T 5 2

♦ K Q 4

♣ K J 6

♠ 8 5

♥ K 9 4 3

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 9 7



♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4

♠ T 3

♥ A Q J 6

♦ T 8 5

♣ T 8 3 2

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

1 ♥

1 ♠

Pass

All Pass

Pass

4 ♠

4 ♠ by East

EAST has an opening hand, 15 points and five ♠s. But NORTH beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

WEST has 11 points, and if EAST had opened she would make a Limit Raise to 3 ♠.

But when replying to an Overcall, the strength needs to be a little higher. In Deal 1 it was OK to pass a 1 ♠ Overcall with 6 points, here it is correct to just raise to 2 ♠ with 11 points.

EAST actually has a strong Overcall so he bids 4 ♠.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ T 8
 ♥ K 9 6 3
 ♦ J 8 5 2
 ♣ A Q 3

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ T 5 2

♦ A K

♣ K 8 6 2



♠ 5 3

♥ A Q J 4

♦ Q T 4 3

♣ T 9 7

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ J 5 4

This time SOUTH has just 10 points, nowhere near an opening hand. Still, when EAST opens 1♥ SOUTH should Overcall 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

NORTH has 13 points. If SOUTH had actually OPENED 1♠, NORTH would insist on game. But SOUTH didn't Open, she just Overcalled. So NORTH must be more cautious. He jumps to 3♠ and SOUTH shows her minimum type hand by passing.

West

North

East

South

1♥

1♠

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ A T 5 3

♥ T 7 5

♦ Q 8

♣ A 8 6 2

♠ Q J 7

♥ K 9 8 2

♦ J 6 5 2

♣ J 4



♠ K 9 8 6

♥ 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ K Q 7 5

♠ 4 2

♥ A Q J 6 3

♦ T 9 4

♣ T 9 3

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

1 ♥

Dbl

Pass

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

EAST has 15 points, a singleton in the opponent's suit and 4-card support for any suit partner might name. In other words, a perfect Takeout Double.

WEST needs to make a medium-strong bid to apprise EAST of her 10 points. She jumps to 2 ♠.

EAST's hand is now worth 17 points because of the singleton. Since he is quite happy with ♠s he bids 4 ♠.

Board 5

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J T 8

♥ K T 8

♦ T 7 5

♣ Q T 5

♠ 7 6 4 2

♥ 7 6 3

♦ 8 6 4

♣ J 9 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 9

♥ Q 9 5

♦ A 9 3 2

♣ A 6 3

♠ 5 3

♥ A J 4 2

♦ K Q J

♣ K 7 4 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♣

All Pass

2♣ by North

1♠

Dbl

SOUTH has 14 points, a doubleton in the opponent's ♠ suit and at least three cards in each of the other suits. This is a normal Takeout Double.

NORTH has a really awful hand. He has just one point and his only 4-card suit is the one the opponents have already bid. He wants nothing more than to pass.

But he cannot pass. Partner's Double said "Bid your best suit.", so he bids 2♣.

Mercifully SOUTH also passes.

Board 6

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 8 5
 ♥ K Q T 5
 ♦ A K 3
 ♣ 4 2

♠ K 2

♥ A 8 4 2

♦ T 7 4

♣ J 9 7 5



♠ A J T 7

♥ J 7

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ A 8 3

♠ 6 4 3

♥ 9 6 3

♦ 8 6 2

♣ K Q T 6

With 14 points, ♣ shortage, and support for the other suits WEST makes a Takeout Double.

EAST has 13 points so she bids 2♣. This is an artificial bid, apprising WEST of EAST's opening hand strength, and forcing the partnership to reach the game level.

WEST suggests ♥s as trumps. EAST doesn't like ♥s so she suggests ♠s. WEST agrees with ♠s and bids game, 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Dbl	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♥	Pass	2♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			
4♠ by East			

Board 7

West Deals

None Vul

♠ T 6
♥ K Q 4 3
♦ T 7 6
♣ K T 9 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ 9 6 5 2

♦ Q 5

♣ A 8 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 5 2

♥ A J T 8

♦ 9 8 4 2

♣ Q J 4

♠ A K J 9 8 3

♥ 7

♦ A K J 3

♣ 7 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	Pass	Dbl
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

WEST's 1 ♥ opening is passed around to SOUTH.
He is tempted to overcall 1 ♠, but with 18 points is a
little strong for a mere overcall. Instead, he doubles.

With 8 points NORTH is not strong enough to jump.
She bids 2 ♣.

SOUTH now bids 2 ♠. By doubling first, then
bidding his own suit, he shows a good suit and 17+
points.

NORTH raises to 4 ♠.

Board 8

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 9
 ♥ K Q 8
 ♦ Q 7 4
 ♣ A Q 8 5

♠ K Q 4 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ J 8 3

♣ J 7 4



♠ 8 7

♥ A 9 7 6

♦ A 6 2

♣ K 9 6 3

♠ T 6 5 3

♥ J T 4

♦ K T 9 5

♣ T 2

WEST has 18 points, a balanced hand, and a good stopper in their suit. He should overcall 1NT. For 1NT overcalls, the range is increased to 15-18 points.

EAST bids 2♣ (Stayman), just as she would with a 1NT opening. When WEST denies holding a 4-card Major EAST has enough points to bid 3NT. She doesn't worry about a ♠ stopper since WEST promised he had the suit controlled.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
1NT	Pass	2 ♣	Pass
2 ♦	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			

Board 9

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 4
♥ 9 5 3
♦ K Q 2
♣ A T 7 2

♠ A 8 6

♥ K Q J

♦ A J 9 7

♣ K Q 4



♠ K Q 3

♥ A T 8

♦ T 5 4 3

♣ 9 5 3

♠ J T 5 2

♥ 7 6 4 2

♦ 8 6

♣ J 8 6

NORTH has 20 points, excellent ♦ stoppers and a balanced hand. She is two points too strong to overcall 1NT. Instead, she doubles.

SOUTH has an awful hand - but since he is forced to bid he says 1♠, assuming NORTH wants to hear his best suit.

NORTH now bids 1NT, showing the balanced 19-21 point hand. SOUTH passes, of course.

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Dbl	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	1NT		
All Pass			
1NT by North			

Board 10

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ K J 6 2

♥ 6 5

♦ A Q 3

♣ 9 8 7 4

♠ A 8 5

♥ 9 7 3 2

♦ 9 8 6

♣ 5 3 2



♠ Q 7 4

♥ A Q T

♦ K J 7 5

♣ A K 6

♠ T 9 3

♥ K J 8 4

♦ T 4 2

♣ Q J T

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

1 ♥

Dbl

Pass

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

EAST has a 19 point balanced hand, including a stop in ♥s. He plans to double, then bid NT. (see Deal 9)

WEST has 10 points though, so he jumps to 2 ♠.

In theory EAST could now bid 2NT to continue the description of his hand, but he might as well go ahead and bid 3NT instead.

Board 11

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6
 ♥ K J T 9
 ♦ A 7 6 5
 ♣ T 8 5

♠ K J 4 2

♥ A 8 5

♦ K J 3 2

♣ J 2



♠ 8 7
 ♥ Q 7 3 2
 ♦ 9 8 4
 ♣ K Q 6 3

♠ A Q T 5 3

♥ 6 4

♦ Q T

♣ A 9 7 4

West	North	East	South
		1 ♥	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 13 points SOUTH should overcall 1 ♠.

NORTH has 13 points and four ♠s. If SOUTH had opened, NORTH's hand would be good enough to insist on game. But since SOUTH overcalled, NORTH merely invites with a jump to 3 ♠.

SOUTH has better than a minimum overcall so she accepts the invitation and bids 4 ♠.

Board 12

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 3
♥ K Q 9 8 6 4
♦ A 5 2
♣ 9 5

♠ T 9 8 7
♥ 2
♦ Q T 9 7 4
♣ T 6 2



♠ K J 6 4
♥ J T 7 5
♦ 6
♣ A K J 3

♠ A 5 2
♥ A 3
♦ K J 8 3
♣ Q 8 7 4

West

North
1♦East
DblSouth
Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by West

EAST has a very minimum Takeout Double of 1♦. But what it lacks in strength, it makes up for with perfect distribution.

WEST has 13 points and only wants to play in one contract, 4♥.

EAST passes happily.

Board 13

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 3 2
 ♥ A 6 4
 ♦ 8 5 3 2
 ♣ 7 6 5

♠ J 7 6

♥ T 5 2

♦ A J 9 4

♣ K T 2



♠ K Q 5

♥ 9 8 3

♦ K T 7

♣ J 9 8 3

♠ A T 9 4

♥ K Q J 7

♦ Q 6

♣ A Q 4

SOUTH has 18 points, a doubleton in the opponent's suit, and at least three cards in the unbid suits. This is an ideal hand for a Takeout Double.

NORTH has good strength in EAST's ♦ suit, probably two stoppers. He has 9 points and no 4-card suit of his own. This is the type of hand to respond 1NT.

SOUTH is happy to play Notrump now that she knows the ♦ s are covered, so she bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	Dbl
Pass	1NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

Board 14

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K 9 6 4

♥ Q 5

♦ K 7 4

♣ J T 7

♠ T 7 3

♥ T 8 6

♦ Q T 8 2

♣ 6 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 8

♥ A J 9 2

♦ A J 6

♣ Q 9 8 3

♠ J 5 2

♥ K 7 4 3

♦ 9 5 3

♣ A K 2

WEST has an opening hand, 14 points and five ♠s. But SOUTH beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

EAST also has 14 points, she doesn't care too much for ♠s, but she has an excellent stopper in ♥s. She jumps to 2NT, inviting WEST to bid game.

Since WEST has several points more than he might have had, and no 6-card ♠ suit to rebid, he happily bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
1 ♠			1 ♥
3NT	Pass	2NT	Pass
All Pass			
3NT by East			

Board 15

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K T 6 4

♥ A 8 6

♦ J T 6

♣ T 5 3

♠ A 9 3

♥ J T 5 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A K 8 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 5 2

♥ 4 2

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ 9 7 2

♠ 8 7

♥ K Q 9 7

♦ A K 8 3

♣ Q J 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

SOUTH has 15 points and all the requirements for a Takeout Double of 1♠.

With 14 points of his own, NORTH knows his side needs to be in a game somewhere. He passes this information to SOUTH with a cue-bid of 2♠.

SOUTH gets the message and starts the hunt for a trump fit by bidding 3♥. That makes it easy for NORTH - he bids 4♥.

Board 16

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q J 6 4 2

♥ A 7

♦ J 7 2

♣ A 8

♠ 9 8

♥ K T 9 4

♦ A 8 4

♣ Q T 5 3



♠ K 7 5

♥ 8 5 2

♦ K Q 3

♣ 9 7 6 2

♠ T 3

♥ Q J 6 3

♦ T 9 6 5

♣ K J 4

There is only one reason that WEST should not overcall with 1♠. He is too strong. The maximum strength of an overcall is 16 points. Above that you should double.

So WEST doubles, and after EAST bids 2♣, WEST bids 2♠. This shows an overcall type hand, but with 17 or more points.

EAST has fine trump support and 8 points so she bids a confident 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Dbl	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♠	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			
4♠ by West			

Board 17

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A T 5
 ♥ Q T 5
 ♦ A J T 9
 ♣ T 4 3

♠ K 9 8 3

♥ 7 6

♦ K Q 5

♣ A J 7 6



♠ 7 6 4

♥ J 9 8 2

♦ 8 6 3 2

♣ 9 5

♠ Q J 2

♥ A K 4 3

♦ 7 4

♣ K Q 8 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	Pass	Dbl
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			

NORTH has 13 points but has no bid over 1 ♦.
 SOUTH can make a Takeout Double, so he does.

NORTH now cue-bids ♦ to show opening hand strength.

SOUTH shows his ♥ suit, NORTH doesn't like it.
 NORTH shows her ♠ suit, SOUTH doesn't like it.
 SOUTH shows his ♣ suit, NORTH likes it fine, but decides 3NT will be easier than 5 ♣.

Board 18

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 3
♥ T 9 4
♦ T 3 2
♣ A 8 7 4

♠ 9 6

♥ Q 6 5

♦ J 7 5 4

♣ K T 6 2



♠ K 5 2

♥ K J 8 2

♦ K Q 9

♣ Q J 3

♠ A J T 7 4

♥ A 7 3

♦ A 8 6

♣ 9 5

SOUTH would have had a great opening 1♠ bid. But when EAST opened 1♠ in front of him he was hornswaggled. He couldn't bid any other suit, he couldn't bid 1NT and he sure couldn't bid ♠s. So he must pass.

And so does everybody else pass.

West

North

East

South

1♠

All Pass

1♠ by East

Board 19

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ T 6
♥ K T 9 8
♦ J T 7
♣ K J 9 8

♠ A 8 2

♥ J 5 2

♦ K 9 8 6

♣ 7 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 4

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ A 5 4 2

♣ A Q T 4

♠ K Q J 9 7 5 3

♥ 7 4

♦ Q 3

♣ 6 2

West

North

East

South

1♣

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

If East had passed, SOUTH would have opened with a preemptive 3♠.

She should make the same bid with the same hand AFTER the opponents open. And she makes it for the same reason, to describe her hand and to take away bidding space from the opponents.

NORTH treats it just like a Preemptive 3-bid, even though it is now called a Weak Jump Overcall. In this case, NORTH passes.

Board 20

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J T 8 5
♥ 6 3
♦ A J T 8 5
♣ 3

♠ 9 4

♥ A T 9 2

♦ Q 7 2

♣ Q 7 5 2



♠ K 7 2

♥ Q J 5 4

♦ 6 3

♣ 9 8 6 4

♠ Q 6 3

♥ K 8 7

♦ K 9 4

♣ A K J T

WEST has 12 points, but with two 5-card suits worthy of an overcall. There isn't really a right and wrong here, but it usually works out best to overcall in the higher-ranking suit. That leaves open the possibility of bidding the second suit later.

In this Deal, after WEST overcalls 1♠, that later possibility never happens because everybody should pass.

West

North

East

South

1♠

All Pass

1♠ by West

1♣

Board 21

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 8 6
♥ Q 8 6 3
♦ 9 8 4 3
♣ 8 5

♠ K J 9
♥ A K J 5
♦ Q 7 5
♣ A T 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 5 3
♥ 4 2
♦ A K 2
♣ J 7 6 4 2

♠ T 7 4 2
♥ T 9 7
♦ J T 6
♣ K Q 9

West

North
1 ♠

East

South

All Pass

1 ♠ by North

EAST has 13 points but she has to pass. She cannot Double without support for ♥s. She cannot bid 1NT without 2 more points. She cannot overcall 2♣ with a terrible suit like that.

And WEST of course must also pass.

Board 22

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9
♥ A T 8 4
♦ 9 6 3
♣ K 6 5 4

♠ T 3

♥ K J 7 6

♦ K J 5

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ 7 6 5

♥ 9 5 3

♦ A T 4 2

♣ J T 9

♠ K Q J 8 4 2

♥ Q 2

♦ Q 8 7

♣ 8 3

SOUTH obviously has to pass when EAST opens 1♠.

NORTH has a reasonable Takeout Double. She hopes SOUTH will name a suit and they can just play a partscore.

You should almost always bid when partner makes a Takeout Double. Almost always. This is the one time when you don't. SOUTH's ♠ are so good that he passes, converting the Takeout Double into a Penalty Double.

West	North	East	South
		1♠	Pass
Pass	Dbl		
All Pass			
1♠ by East			

Board 23

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ T 9 4
♥ T 7 6
♦ J T 4
♣ A J T 7

♠ Q J 5
♥ A K Q 2
♦ A 9 8 5
♣ 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6 3
♥ 5 4 3
♦ Q 3 2
♣ K Q 9 8 3

♠ A K 8 7 2
♥ J 9 8
♦ K 7 6
♣ 6 5

West	North	East	South
		1 ♣	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

SOUTH has a normal overcall of 1 ♠.

NORTH has a really good hand, but he doesn't have to worry about missing a slam since SOUTH will not have more than 16 points. So he just bids what he thinks SOUTH can make, 4 ♠.

Board 24

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 6 5
♥ 8 4
♦ K J T 3
♣ A J 8 4

♠ J 7 4 2
♥ A T 9
♦ 7 4 2
♣ K 9 3



♠ K Q 3
♥ K Q J 5 3
♦ 9 6 5
♣ T 6

♠ A 9 8
♥ 7 6 2
♦ A Q 8
♣ Q 7 5 2

West	North	East	South
	1♦	1♥	Pass
1NT			
All Pass			
1NT by West			

EAST has 12 points and a good enough suit to overcall 1♥.

WEST has 9 points with a good ♦ stopper. She bids 1NT.

EAST has nothing more to say, and lets WEST play 1NT.